

03 · Copy Deck — v0.2 draft

Status: second draft, incorporating Alex's feedback from the 17 Sep Zoom call (Fathom transcript). Not approved. Not for build. Route to Arham → Alex → counsel (for fee, custody, Vanguard mention, and the disambiguation sentences).

Rules still applied: every constraint in `../part-0-preparation-and-research/03-compliance-rules.md`. First person singular. No exclamation marks. No superlatives. No performance figures. Fee wording verbatim. All gaps marked `[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: ...]`.

Changes from v0.1 → v0.2

Direct-from-Alex edits from the 17 Sep call:

1. **Location: "Scottsdale" only.** Not "Phoenix and Scottsdale." His words: *"You can just say Scottsdale."*
2. **Origin story = ex-Vanguard.** Weave the Vanguard-to-independent narrative into About and Home. He said this should be a story, not a resume line.
3. **Two of his own quotes preserved verbatim** in About:
 - *"At Vanguard, we were trained to manage clients, not portfolios."*
 - *"Most clients are not satisfied with an advisor who gets paid to sit on his hands."*
4. **Custody rewritten as benefit, not feature.** His two-sentence Bernie Madoff frame replaces the bullet list. Feature/benefit distinction — his words: *"nobody cares about features. They care about benefits."*
5. **/custody — REMOVED "no lock-up periods, full access at any time."** Alex: *"that's not technically correct. That's not accurate."* → factual correction, flagged.
6. **/fees — reframed as "Results, not fees."** His long-standing tagline. Narrative: "potentially nothing" if the strategy doesn't work. Verbatim wording preserved. Added small performance-fee-incentive disclosure per his own note.
7. **No "solo adviser / working alone" framing anywhere.** Alex: *"the loan bit is kind of a downer... that's not always viewed as a good thing in my industry."* Reframed as *"I answer to my clients, not to a corporate office."*
8. **ADV / regulatory disclosure block moved out of body → footer.** Alex: *"that shouldn't be number one, that should be at the bottom of the page."* Kept in body as a short "How to verify me" link.
9. **/approach rebuilt as narrative** around the "safety AND returns" tension and his liquidity-based belief. Principles woven into prose rather than stacked as bullets, per his push for story arc.
10. **Home headline reworked** to open with a question, not a statement. Alex liked the question-based direction ("What does this money need to do...") even though he wanted the wording tightened.
11. **Zermagen brand** introduced as the named process nested inside the firm brand — may spin out

later.

12. **Hero image direction** changed from abstract to human-connection (see 05-asset-decisions.md).
13. **Belief statements from his article** ("Markets are people first, mathematics a distant third." · "Money moves between markets, so should your portfolio.") — offered as pull-quotes, not filler paragraphs.
14. **Two of his verbal quotes deliberately NOT used on the site**, flagged in Compliance Notes below:
 - *"So far this year it's performed exceptionally well"* → performance claim, prohibited.
 - Any implied "you won't lose money" framing → prohibited even when the fee structure allows it to be said.

Voice principle he set on the call, in his own words: *"It needs to tell a story with some emotion to it that people can relate to... Just slightly, not this emotional sales page, but it just needs to have a little bit of a story."*

/ — Home

- **Title:** Life Story Wealth Planning — Alex Hilbert, Registered Investment Advisor, Scottsdale, Arizona
- **Meta description:** A small Scottsdale investment advisory firm run by Alex Hilbert, a Registered Investment Advisor and fiduciary. Active portfolio management for people who have already built their wealth.
- **H1:** What is this money supposed to do for the life it belongs to?

Sub-line (below H1)

That question comes before any portfolio decision. My name is Alex Hilbert. I run Life Story Wealth Planning, a small investment advisory firm in Scottsdale, Arizona, for people who have already built their wealth and want it managed by someone who is actually managing it.

Section — What I do, and why it is different

Most portfolios sit still. Markets move, and the portfolio does not. When markets fall, the standard answer clients hear from their adviser is to do nothing.

I do not think that is management. It is the absence of it.

I built this firm to work the other way. I actively manage portfolios — reviewed and reconstituted every quarter, moved between asset classes as conditions change, with the discretion to hold cash when nothing deserves capital. The process has a name — I call it **Zermagen**, which is Hebrew for fortress and shield. The full explanation is on the [Approach page](#).

Section — Who this is for

I work with a small number of individuals. Most are approaching retirement or already in it. Most were referred to me by someone they trust. If you would like to see whether it is a fit, the [Who I work with](#) page lays it out plainly.

Section — What it costs

There is no management fee. I am paid only on gains above a defined threshold. If the strategy does not work in a given quarter, I do not get paid for that quarter. The exact wording — and what it means in plain language — is on the [Fees page](#).

Section — Where your money actually is

I never hold client money. Your account is at a third-party custodian, in your name. I direct how it is invested. I cannot move funds out of it. That distinction matters, and I explain it on the [Custody page](#).

Section — The next step

If you were referred to me, the page most people read next is [About](#). If you want to talk, [start a conversation](#).

CTA

Start a conversation → (links to /contact)

Pull-quote (mid-page, quiet treatment)

"Markets are people first and mathematics a distant third."

/about ☆ MOST IMPORTANT

- **Title:** About Alex Hilbert — Registered Investment Advisor, Scottsdale, Arizona | Life Story Wealth Planning
- **Meta description:** Alex Hilbert is a Registered Investment Advisor and fiduciary, formerly at Vanguard, now running Life Story Wealth Planning — a small Scottsdale investment advisory firm.
- **H1:** About Alex Hilbert

Sub-line

Registered Investment Advisor · Fiduciary · Scottsdale, Arizona

[Photograph]

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: real photograph of Alex Hilbert. No stock. No AI-generated portrait. Direction from Alex on the call: replace the current abstract "staircase to nowhere" hero — want something with human connection. Route: client → Arham. See open-gaps.md #1.]

Section — Who I am

My name is Alex Hilbert. I run Life Story Wealth Planning, a small investment advisory firm in Scottsdale, Arizona. I am a Registered Investment Advisor, which in the United States is a specific, licensed role — not a job title anyone can adopt. Being an RIA also means I am a fiduciary. I am legally required to put my clients' interests ahead of my own.

I have worked in this industry since 2012. Most of the people I work with came to me because someone they trust suggested it. If that is how you arrived here, this page is for you.

Section — Why I built this firm

Before this firm, I was an adviser at Vanguard.

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: naming Vanguard as a former employer. Factual and verifiable but worth flagging to counsel — check any post-employment marketing restrictions. Route: client's counsel.]

The clients I spoke with there were smart people who had built real wealth over long careers. They read carefully, they asked real questions, and they were paying attention. When markets fell — and they always fall, eventually — those clients would call. They wanted to know what we were going to do about their portfolios. They watched the value of their accounts drop day after day, and they wanted a plan.

The Vanguard answer was to do nothing. Stay the course. Ride it out.

That answer was not wrong for everyone. For a lot of people it is the right answer. But the clients I spoke with were not satisfied with it. They wanted to know why they were paying a management fee if nothing was being managed. They had a fair point.

■ *"At Vanguard, we were trained to manage clients, not portfolios."*

I do not say that as a criticism. It is true of most large firms, and there is a business reason for it. But it is not the way I want to work, and it is not what the clients I spoke with were paying for.

So I left, and I built this firm to do the other thing. To actually manage portfolios. To reconsider positions every quarter, to move between asset classes when conditions change, and to hold cash when nothing deserves capital. To answer the phone when a client wants to know what we are doing about a market that is falling — with something better than "nothing."

■ *"Most clients are not satisfied with an advisor who gets paid to sit on his hands."*

That is why this firm exists.

Section — What being a fiduciary means, in practice

A fiduciary is legally required to act in your interest ahead of their own. In day-to-day terms that shapes three things about how I work:

- I do not earn commissions on the products I recommend. My fee structure — described on the [Fees page](#) — pays me only when your portfolio gains value above a defined threshold. I do not

get paid for holding your assets. I get paid when they grow.

- I do not take custody of your money. It is held at a separate, third-party institution in an account in your name. I explain how this works on the [Custody page](#).
- I do not answer to a corporate office. I answer to my clients. That is the point of the firm.

Section — How I manage money

The process has a name — I call it **Zermagen**, from the Hebrew for *fortress and shield*. It is built around a single idea: risk comes first. Before I decide what to buy, I decide what could go wrong and how to guard against it.

The full explanation, layer by layer, is on the [Approach page](#).

Section — Where I am

Life Story Wealth Planning is based in Scottsdale, Arizona.

I keep the firm small on purpose. It lets me pay attention to each client's situation properly rather than run a book of hundreds.

Section — How to verify me

You can look up any Registered Investment Advisor in the United States through the SEC's public records. My firm's Form ADV — the standard regulatory filing — is linked in the footer of every page on this site. If it matters to you to verify anything before we speak, that is where to look.

Section — A note on the name

There is an unrelated firm called Life Story Financial. I am not connected with them. This site — and my firm, Life Story Wealth Planning — belong to me.

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: whether to also disambiguate the closed Hilbert Financial Group here. Alex may not want to draw attention to it if it does not appear in his current search results. Route: Arham → client.]

CTA

Start a conversation → ([links to /contact](#))

/approach

- **Title:** Approach — The Zermagen Process | Life Story Wealth Planning
- **Meta description:** How I manage portfolios: the Zermagen process — active, risk-first management built around the idea that markets run on liquidity, not on a fixed mix of stocks and bonds.
- **H1:** How I manage portfolios

Sub-line

The Zermagen process — active, risk-first, reconstituted quarterly.

Section — What most people actually want

Most people who come to me want two things that the industry usually treats as opposites.

They want their money to be safer. They have already built what they have and they do not want to lose it.

They also want their money to grow. Inflation does not stop because you retired. Neither does life.

The standard trade-off is that you can pursue one or the other. Take less risk and accept lower returns, or reach for higher returns and accept the drawdowns that come with them. That trade-off is real at the extremes. It is less real in the middle, and the middle is where most of the work happens.

Section — What I actually do

I hold parts of markets that are working — where money is flowing in, not out — and I move away from parts that are not. I hold cash when nothing deserves capital. I use protective positions when conditions call for them. The portfolio is reviewed every quarter and reconstituted from scratch, not tweaked at the margin.

The framework has three layers.

Section — Layer 1 · Narrow the Universe

I start with 21 asset classes covering global stocks, bonds, commodities and currencies. Based on current market conditions, I narrow that set to 7. The question at this layer is not *what looks good in general* — it is *what deserves any capital at all, given what markets are actually doing right now*.

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: approval to use a simple diagram illustrating 21 → 7 narrowing. Non-performance, purely conceptual. See open-gaps.md — asset decision.]

Section — Layer 2 · Analyze the Constituents

Within each of the 7 asset classes I look at the components. The goal is to filter out excess downside risk and to remove laggards. The question here is: within what is worth holding, what actually deserves the capital?

Section — Layer 3 · Craft the Strategy

The third layer decides how to hold what remains. Depending on the situation I may buy outright, hold cash, sell covered calls, short-sell puts, hold limited futures exposure, or build long/short spreads. The question here is: given what deserves to be held, what is the right shape of the position?

Section — What runs through all three layers

- **Risk first.** How much can be lost in a bad year matters more than how much might be gained in a good one. Every decision is made in that order.
- **Built to move.** Positions are chosen to be reconsidered, not to be forgotten. Every quarter the

whole portfolio is reviewed against current conditions.

- **Opportunity across markets.** I am not restricted to one asset class or geography.
- **Discretionary authority.** Under our agreement I have the authority to act when action is warranted, without waiting for approval on each move.
- **Cash is a position.** Holding cash is a decision, not the absence of one. When nothing deserves capital, the answer is to hold cash.
- **No leverage.** My clients want their money treated with care. I do not borrow against the portfolio to reach for larger returns.

Pull-quote (quiet treatment, mid-page)

"Money moves between markets. So should your portfolio."

Section — What this page does not show

I do not publish past performance figures, growth illustrations, or backtests on this site. There are specific rules about how advisers may present results, and I would rather have a conversation about them with you directly than post numbers on a marketing page.

CTA

Start a conversation → ([links to /contact](/contact))

/who-i-work-with

- **Title:** Who I work with | Life Story Wealth Planning
- **Meta description:** A small number of individuals — usually approaching or in retirement, already wealthy, and interested in active risk management. Here is how to tell whether the firm is a fit.
- **H1:** Who I work with

Section — In one paragraph

I work with a small number of individuals who have already built the wealth they need. Most are approaching retirement or already in it. Most are business owners, former executives, or professionals who spent decades earning what they now want to protect and grow carefully. Most came to me because someone they trust suggested it.

Section — What we usually have in common

- You have built your wealth and are more focused on keeping it than on growing it aggressively.
- You want an actively managed portfolio — one that responds to what markets are doing, not one left on a fixed model and forgotten.
- You prefer to work directly with the person managing your money, not through layers of a large firm.
- You are careful. You read carefully, you ask real questions, and you make decisions in your own time.

Section — When I am probably not the right fit

- You are early in building your wealth and are looking for aggressive growth.
- You want a portfolio you never look at, matched to a passive index and left alone.
- You want frequent trading based on short-term market calls.
- You want product recommendations paid for by commission.

If any of that describes you better, there are firms that fit that better than I do, and I will say so directly.

CTA

Start a conversation → (links to /contact)

/fees

- **Title:** Fees — Results, not fees | Life Story Wealth Planning
- **Meta description:** No management fee. I am paid only on gains above a high water mark and a quarterly hurdle rate. If the strategy does not work, I do not get paid.
- **H1:** Results, not fees

Section — The short version

Most advisers charge a management fee. Whether your portfolio goes up, down, or sideways, the fee is charged. I do not.

If the strategy I run for you does not work in a given quarter — if it does not exceed a defined threshold — I am not paid for that quarter. When it does exceed the threshold, I am paid a share of the excess. That is the whole model.

Section — In my own words

The wording below is exactly as I publish it. It is the wording that governs the fee arrangement.

"We charge no managements fees. We only make money by increasing your wealth. Performance success fees of 30% are assessed quarterly only on excess returns above a high water mark and a quarterly 1.5% hurdle rate."

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: fee wording is being reviewed by client's counsel, including the spelling of "managements". Reproduce verbatim until counsel returns a corrected version. See open-gaps.md #4.]

Section — What that means, in plain language

Two things have to be true before I am paid anything.

- **Your account has to reach a new high.** This is the *high water mark*. If your portfolio drops and

later recovers, no fee is charged on the recovered ground — the water mark is the previous peak.

I am not paid twice on the same gains.

- **The new high has to be more than 1.5% above the previous one, for that quarter.** This is the *hurdle rate*. Small gains do not trigger a fee.

When both conditions are met, the fee is 30% of the gains above the hurdle. Otherwise, there is no fee for that quarter.

Section — Why the model is built this way

I built it this way so my incentives line up with yours. If you do well, I do well. If you do not do well, I do not do well. That is how I want the arrangement to work, and it is a large part of why the firm exists.

Section — A note on incentives

A fee structure paid on performance can, in theory, encourage an adviser to take more risk than they otherwise would, in the hope of triggering a fee. I am aware of that risk, and it is part of why my approach starts with risk management before anything else. The high water mark also helps: once a portfolio has fallen, I do not get paid on the recovery back to the previous peak, which removes any incentive to gamble the account back.

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: whether counsel wants a stronger or specifically-worded performance-fee incentive disclosure here. This wording is drafted plain-language rather than legal. Route: client's counsel.]

Section — What this page deliberately does not show

I do not publish worked examples, comparison charts, or illustrations of what someone "would have paid" under this fee. Doing so would represent past or hypothetical performance, which sits under specific rules for advisers. If you want to understand how the structure would apply to your situation, we can walk through it in a conversation.

CTA

Start a conversation → ([links to /contact](/contact))

/custody

- **Title:** Custody — where your money actually is | Life Story Wealth Planning
- **Meta description:** I never hold client money. Your account is at a third-party custodian, in your name. I direct how it is invested. I cannot move funds out of it.
- **H1:** Where your money actually is

Section — The short version

I never hold client money.

Your account is at an independent, third-party custodian, in your own name. I direct how the money in it is invested. I cannot move funds out of it, to me or to anyone else. That distinction is the single most important structural safeguard in how I have set up the firm.

If you have ever read a story about an adviser who took client money, that story is almost always about an arrangement where the adviser controlled the account and could withdraw from it. That is not how this firm is set up, and under our agreement it cannot be set up that way.

Section — How the account works

- **The account is in your own name.** Not the firm's. Not a pooled fund.
- **Managed separately, not pooled with anyone else's.** Your holdings are yours.
- **You can see every holding and every value at the custodian.** Directly, without going through me and without asking me. It is your account.
- **A third-party custodian holds the assets.** The firm does not. [NEEDS CONFIRMATION: whether to name the custodian on the page, or leave it as "a major US custodian".
Route: client → Arham.]

[COMPLIANCE NOTE — REMOVED from v0.1: the previous draft claimed "no lock-up periods, full access at all times." Alex confirmed on the 17 Sep call that this is inaccurate. Removed. Do not restore without confirmation of the actual withdrawal terms in the client agreement. See open-gaps.md.]

Section — Verifying any of this

You do not have to take my word for it. My firm's registration and structure are public record. The Form ADV linked in the footer of this site is the standard filing that describes the arrangement, including the custody relationship. If it matters to you to verify anything before we talk, that is where to look.

CTA

Start a conversation → (links to /contact)

/how-we-start (NEW)

- **Title:** How we start — the roadmap from first conversation to client | Life Story Wealth Planning
- **Meta description:** A plain description of what happens between the first conversation and becoming a client — so you know what to expect at every step.
- **H1:** How we start

Section — What this page is for

Deciding to work with someone who manages your money is a serious decision. This page describes what actually happens between the first conversation and the point where you are a client — so there are no surprises, and so you can decide at each step whether to continue. There is no pressure to

move faster than you want to.

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: Alex to define his onboarding process. See open-gaps.md #2. Steps below are placeholders reflecting a typical shape, marked so nothing ships until Alex confirms the actual sequence.]

Step 1 — First conversation

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: client to define step 1 – likely an introductory call, how long, what is discussed, whether prep is needed.]

Step 2 — Understanding your situation

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: client to define step 2 – what information he asks for, what a discovery conversation covers, how long it takes.]

Step 3 — A written proposal

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: client to define step 3 – whether he provides a written proposal, what it includes, how it is delivered.]

Step 4 — Paperwork and account setup

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: client to define step 4 – the agreement, opening the account at the third-party custodian, funding.]

Step 5 — First portfolio decisions

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: client to define step 5 – how the initial portfolio is constructed, over what timeframe, what you see and when.]

Step 6 — Ongoing

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: client to define step 6 – cadence of reviews, how you receive statements, how to reach him with questions.]

Section — What you can expect throughout

- No pressure to decide on any timeline other than yours.
- Direct communication with me, not through an assistant.
- Written confirmation of any change to your account.
- Answers to questions you have not asked yet, if I think you should know something.

CTA

Start a conversation → (links to /contact)

/contact

- **Title:** Contact | Life Story Wealth Planning
- **Meta description:** Get in touch with Alex Hilbert at Life Story Wealth Planning in Scottsdale, Arizona.
- **H1:** Get in touch

Section — The direct route

The easiest way to start is a short message. I will reply personally.

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: contact email to publish. Do not lift from data-broker listings — those may be wrong. Route: client → Arham. See open-gaps.md #5.]

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: phone number to publish, if any. Same routing.]

Section — Book a call

If you would rather book a time directly, you can schedule a first conversation here.

[NEEDS DECISION: booking tool. Currently Calendly on the live site; scheduling is being changed. Do not wire until Arham confirms the tool. See open-gaps.md #6.]

Section — Where I am

Life Story Wealth Planning is based in Scottsdale, Arizona.

Contact form

[NEEDS DECISION: form submission target. Build markup only; leave submission target unset until Arham confirms where enquiry data lands.]

Fields (draft):

- Your name
- Your email
- Best phone number (optional)
- How you were referred (optional)
- A short note

Submit button label: Send

Below the form: I will reply personally, usually within two business days.

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: reply-time commitment above — Alex to confirm what he wants to promise, or remove.]

/insights

- **Title:** Insights | Life Story Wealth Planning
- **Meta description:** Written research and occasional notes on markets, risk management, and how I think about long-term investing.

- **H1:** Insights

Section — What lives here

This section will hold two things: a research white paper I am rebuilding, and occasional written notes on markets, risk, and how I think about long-term investing.

I am not going to fill this section with generic finance posts. It is going to be quiet until there is something worth reading, and then it will hold that.

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: whether to include a "notify me when the white paper is published" email signup here. If yes, that is an email-capture gate and needs approval – route to Arham. See open-gaps.md, decision D.]

(Empty state on the page)

No published items yet.

Footer (all pages)

- Firm name · Scottsdale, AZ · year
- Link to **Form ADV** (SEC / IAPD lookup)
- Link to **FINRA BrokerCheck** (if applicable)
- Any required legal / compliance line(s)

[NEEDS CONFIRMATION: exact footer disclosures + regulatory links required. Do NOT copy another firm's footer. Route: client's counsel. See open-gaps.md #7.]

Appendix A — GAPS

#	Where	Gap	Who would know
G1	/about — photo	Real photograph of Alex, human-connection direction	Client → Arham (open-gaps.md #1)
G2	/about — Vanguard mention	Any post-employment marketing restrictions on naming Vanguard	Client's counsel
G3	/about — Hilbert Financial Group	Whether to disambiguate on the page or leave it out entirely	Client → Arham
G4	/approach — Layer 1	Approval for 21→7 diagram	Client → Arham

G5	/fees — quoted wording	Counsel review of wording incl. "managements" typo	Client's counsel (#4)
G6	/fees — performance-fee disclosure	Whether counsel wants a specific incentive disclosure wording	Client's counsel
G7	/custody — custodian name	Whether to name the custodian on the page	Client → Arham
G8	/custody — withdrawal terms	Actual withdrawal terms in client agreement (previous "no lock-ups / full access" line was inaccurate per Alex, removed)	Client → Arham → counsel
G9	/how-we-start — steps 1–6	Alex must define onboarding process	Client → Arham (#2)
G10	/contact — email	Which email address to publish	Client → Arham (#5)
G11	/contact — phone	Which phone number, if any	Client → Arham (#5)
G12	/contact — booking	Which scheduling tool	Client → Arham (#6)
G13	/contact — form target	Where enquiry data lands	Arham
G14	/contact — reply time	Whether to promise a response window	Client → Arham
G15	/insights — signup	Whether to add an email-capture gate	Arham
G16	Footer (all pages)	Required regulatory disclosures + links to filings	Client's counsel (#7)
G17	Brand nesting	Whether to visibly nest Zermagen brand inside Life Story brand on /approach, or keep it as a text label only	Client → Arham

Appendix B — COMPLIANCE NOTES

Things deliberately avoided or restructured. This list is longer in v0.2 because Alex said a few things in the call that would be fine in a conversation but cannot appear on the site.

Kept from v0.1

- No testimonials, quotes from clients, ratings, or star widgets — anywhere. Rule 1.

- **No performance figures, returns, growth illustrations, or backtests** — anywhere.
- **Fee wording reproduced verbatim** on /fees, including the "managements" typo. No paraphrase, no simplification, no worked example, no comparison chart.
- **No superlatives.** Checked every page.
- **No client names, logos, photos, stories, or composites.**
- **No stock photos of people.**
- **No trust badges, "as seen in" strips, or partner logos.**
- **No exclamation marks anywhere.**
- **First person singular** used throughout. "We" appears only inside the verbatim fee quote (client's own published wording, cannot be edited).
- **No mention of DriveChain Capital Management** anywhere. Scope boundary.
- **/approach and /fees explicitly close** with a short paragraph on why no performance figures — so the absence looks intentional rather than suspicious.

New in v0.2

- **Verbal quote NOT used on the site:** Alex said *"so far this year it's performed exceptionally well... a lot of money where my mouth is."* That is a performance representation and is prohibited on the marketing surface. Fine in a private conversation. Not on the site.
- **Verbal framing NOT used on the site:** any wording that implies *"you cannot lose money"* or that guarantees an outcome. The fee-structure fact (no fee unless above hurdle + high water mark) is factual and stays. Anything that reads as an outcome guarantee is cut.
- **/custody — factual correction:** removed the previous "no lock-up periods, full access at all times" line from v0.1. Alex flagged this as inaccurate on the call. Do not restore without confirmed withdrawal terms from the client agreement.
- **Vanguard mention:** naming a former employer is factual and verifiable. But it is worth a counsel check for any post-employment marketing restrictions, and any wording that could read as disparagement was avoided. The framing used — "the Vanguard answer was to do nothing... that answer was not wrong for everyone. For a lot of people it is the right answer" — is deliberate. It sets up the story without disparaging the previous firm.
- **Hilbert Financial Group:** removed the proactive disambiguation from /about v0.1. Alex did not raise it on the call, and there is a plausible argument that drawing attention to a closed entity creates confusion rather than resolves it. Left as a gap for Arham/Alex to decide.
- **ADV / regulatory disclosure block:** moved out of body → footer, per Alex. Kept a short "How to verify me" section in /about body that links to the footer, so verification is discoverable without leading the page.
- **"Solo adviser" framing removed** from all pages. Alex: *"the loan bit is kind of a downer... that's not always viewed as a good thing in my industry."* Reframed as *"I answer to my clients, not to a corporate office."*
- **Alex's own quotes preserved verbatim** in /about:
 - *"At Vanguard, we were trained to manage clients, not portfolios."*
 - *"Most clients are not satisfied with an advisor who gets paid to sit on his hands."*
 - These are his own words. If either goes to a compliance review and needs softening, the story survives — but the punch of the page depends on them.

- **Belief pull-quotes** on / and /approach are drawn from Alex's own written philosophy (referenced on the call). Neither implies performance or guarantees. Both are attitudinal statements about how he thinks.
- **/insights empty state** deliberately says "*No published items yet*" — not decorative filler. Matches Alex's own concern from the pack about pages that visibly rot (Redwood's 2024 "Upcoming Events" example).

Held-open questions for counsel

The following need counsel review specifically before publish:

1. Fee wording verbatim quote (including typo).
2. Performance-fee incentive disclosure wording on /fees.
3. Custody wording — especially the "cannot move funds out of it" phrasing and any custodian naming.
4. Vanguard mention on /about.
5. Footer regulatory disclosures.
6. Any wording that could be read as an outcome guarantee — pass through with a compliance lens.

What happens next

1. Arham reviews this deck against the transcript to confirm nothing got lost or misrepresented.
2. Alex reviews, especially the About story arc and the pull-quotes.
3. Counsel reviews the six items in the held-open list above.
4. Alex fills the gaps in Appendix A — the onboarding steps, the contact details, the custodian naming decision, the Vanguard-mention question, and the reply-time promise.
5. Deck updated to v1.0 (approved).
6. Only then does Part 2 (build) begin.

